

Jon Saad-Falcon

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Education

Stanford University – Palo Alto, CA

June 2023 - June 2028

Joint Ph.D. in Computer Science and Master's in Business Administration (MBA)

GPA: 4.0

- **Advisors:** Christopher Ré and Azalia Mirhoseini

- **Fellowships:** Stanford Graduate Fellowship, JP Morgan AI/ML Fellowship, Stanford EDGE Fellowship, GEM Fellowship

Georgia Institute of Technology (Georgia Tech) - Atlanta, GA

August 2018 - May 2022

B.S. - M.S. in Computer Science

GPA: 3.96

- **Minors:** Mathematics and Linguistics
- **Undergraduate Thesis:** PeopleMap: NLP and Visualization Tool for Mapping Out Researchers
- **Scholarships:** Stamps President's Scholarship (premier full-ride scholarship)

Industry and Research Experiences

Databricks, Office of the CTO, San Francisco, CA

July 2023 - September 2023

Research internship with Prof. Matei Zaharia

- Collaborated with CTO, Matei Zaharia, to tackle pressing research challenges faced by ML engineering teams
- Leveraged statistical inference strategies to create novel automated evaluation system for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG)
- Reduced annotation costs by 95% and increased evaluation speed by 15x for company RAG systems

Fulbright Scholarship, Research Award, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin

September 2022 - July 2023

Research collaboration with Prof. Ulf Leser

- Collaborated with Hospital Charité oncologists to develop AI-powered technique for patient treatment design by using EHRs
- Created relation extraction algorithms for developing knowledge graph of biomedical concepts
- Initiated collaboration with Stanford to build new information retrieval techniques for biomedical documents

Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2), Semantic Scholar, Seattle, WA

August 2021 - August 2022

Predoctoral Young Investigator with Prof. Doug Downey and Prof. Daniel Weld

- Designed new efficiency techniques for caching and reusing sequence representations in language models
- Gained 2x training speedup and 4x inference speedup while achieving state-of-the-art accuracy for core NLP tasks
- Constructed search engine for exploring challenges and future directions within COVID-19 literature

Stanford University, Center for the Study of Language and Information (CSLI), Palo Alto, CA

June 2021 - August 2021

Research internship with Prof. Christopher Potts and Prof. Matei Zaharia

- NSF-Funded research experience for undergraduates with a cohort of 12 students out of 723 applicants
- Constructed new benchmark dataset, LoTTE, for building domain-specific question-answering models
- Experimented with new architectures and retrieval strategies for the state-of-the-art ColBERTv2 model

Goldman Sachs, Global Investment Research, New York City, NY

July - August 2020

Summer Research Analyst

- Initiated independent project using quantitative techniques and NLP tools to perform valuation of companies
- Collaborated with traders and external clients to develop new automated trading strategies
- Assisted energy sector research team as they advise corporate clients on financial decisions

Publications

[1]: Intelligence per Watt: Measuring Intelligence Efficiency of Local AI

Jon Saad-Falcon*, Avanika Narayan*, Orhun Akengin, Wes Griffin, ..., John Hennessy, Azalia Mirhoseini, Christopher Ré
Preprint 2026

[2]: Shrinking the Generation-Verification Gap with Weak Verifiers

Jon Saad-Falcon*, E. Kelly Buchanan*, Mayee F. Chen*, ..., Scott Linderman, Azalia Mirhoseini, Christopher Ré
NeurIPS 2025

[3]: LMUnit: Fine-grained Evaluation with Natural Language Unit Tests

Jon Saad-Falcon*, Rajan Vivek*, William Berrios*, Nandita Naik, ..., Amanpreet Singh, Douwe Kiela, Shikib Mehri
EMNLP 2025

- [4]: *Archon: An Architecture Search Framework for Inference-Time Techniques*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Adrian Gamarra Lafuente, Shlok Natarajan, Nahum Maru, ..., Christopher Ré, Azalia Mirhoseini
ICML 2025
ICLR 2025, Scaling Self-Improving Foundation Models without Human Supervision (SSI FM) **Oral Presentation**
- [5]: *Benchmarking and Building Long-Context Retrieval Models with LoCo and M2-BERT*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Daniel Y. Fu, Simran Arora, Neel Guha, Christopher Ré
ICML 2024
- [6]: *PDFTriage: Question Answering over Long, Structured Documents*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Joe Barrow, Alexa Siu, Ani Nenkova, Seunghyun Yoon, Ryan A. Rossi, Franck Dernoncourt
EMNLP 2024
- [7]: *ARES: An Automated Evaluation Framework for Retrieval-Augmented Generation Systems*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Omar Khattab, Christopher Potts, Matei Zaharia
NAACL 2024, Oral Presentation
- [8]: *UDAPDR: Unsupervised Domain Adaptation via LLM Prompting and Distillation of Rerankers*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Omar Khattab, Keshav Santhanam, Radu Florian, Salim Roukos, ..., Christopher Potts
EMNLP 2023
- [9]: *Moving Beyond Downstream Task Accuracy for Information Retrieval Benchmarking*
Keshav Santhanam*, **Jon Saad-Falcon***, Martin Franz, Omar Khattab, ..., Avi Sil, Matei Zaharia, Christopher Potts
ACL Findings 2023
- [10]: *Embedding Recycling for Language Models*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Amanpreet Singh, Luca Soldaini, Mike D’Arcy, Arman Cohan, Doug Downey
EACL Findings 2023
- [11]: *A Search Engine for Discovery of Scientific Challenges and Directions*
Dan Lahav, **Jon Saad-Falcon**, Bailey Kuehl, ..., Polo Chau, Diyi Yang, Eric Horvitz, Daniel Weld, and Tom Hope
AAAI 2022, Oral Presentation
- [12]: *ColBERTv2: Effective and Efficient Retrieval via Lightweight Late Interaction*
Keshav Santhanam*, Omar Khattab*, **Jon Saad-Falcon**, Christopher Potts, Matei Zaharia
NAACL 2022
- [13]: *Mapping Researchers with PeopleMap*
Jon Saad-Falcon, Omar Shaikh, Zijie Wang, Austin Wright, Sasha Richardson, Polo Chau
IEEE VIS 2020, VAST Best Poster Research Award, Honorable Mention

Honors and Awards

Gates-Cambridge Scholarship , Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation	Spring 2023
Knight-Hennessy Scholarship, Finalist , Stanford University	Spring 2023
GEM Fellowship , National GEM Consortium	Fall 2023
Fulbright Scholarship, Research Award , U.S. State Department and German Federal Foreign Office	Spring 2022
College of Engineering Fellowship , University of California, Berkeley	Spring 2023
Donald V. Jackson Fellowship , Georgia Tech	Spring 2021
President’s Undergraduate Research Award , Georgia Tech	Fall 2020
Summer Venture in Management Program (SVMP) , Harvard Business School	Spring 2022
Computer Science Research Mentorship Program , Google	Spring 2021
D.E. Shaw Nexus Fellowship , D.E. Shaw and Co.	Fall 2020
U.N. Millennium Fellowship , United Nations	Fall 2021

Leadership and Community Engagement

- SoE Dean’s Graduate Student Advisory Council (DGSAC)**, Chair for Computer Science September 2025 - Present
- Built first centralized database of fellowships, RA/CA, and internship opportunities across 9 departments with SoE leadership
 - Connected 30+ students with fellowships, 50+ with internships, and 40+ with RA placements in 2025–26 so far

Georgia Tech Venture Capital Fund, Co-founder and Student Director *January 2021 - July 2022*

- Collaborated with Georgia Tech president's office and alumni association to establish first GT-backed VC fund
- Created educational curriculum for teaching 40+ students on the fundamental strategies of venture capital funds
- Raised an inaugural \$10+ million early-stage fund that started supporting Georgia Tech startups in Spring 2022

Georgia Tech Computer Science Outreach Club, Founding Member and Volunteer *July*

2020 - July 2022

- Developed coding workshops and lectures to teach 50+ underprivileged youth from Atlanta-area highschools
- Assisted students in their college application process as well as guide their preparation for tech company summer programs

Invited Talks and Presentations

EE292P: Atoms, Bits, and National Interest - Stanford University February 2026

Two Sigma January 2026

MBZUAI Speech and NLP Symposium January 2026

Measuring Intelligence Summit at PyTorch Conference October 2025

Together AI July 2025

LLMs Meet Data Processing Workshop - UC Berkeley May 2025

Contextual AI October 2024

Databricks February 2024
